

Mashack, Danielle

From: Danser, Adam
Sent: Tuesday, July 7, 2026 11:28 AM
To: Bradshaw, Kenneth
Subject: FW: Notes from ATC_Summerhill Meeting

From: Danser, Adam <adanser@atlanta.k12.ga.us>
Date: Tuesday, July 7, 2026 at 11:25 AM
To: Montgomery, Chelsea <Chelsea.Montgomer@atlanta.k12.ga.us>, Drake, Daniel <Daniel.Drake@atlanta.k12.ga.us>, Clark Seydel <cseydel@peregrinecrest.com>, Rich Kenah <rkenah@atlantatrackclub.org>
Subject: Notes from ATC_Summerhill Meeting

Good morning all,

Rich, great work on the presentation last night!

I am sure you had someone on your team taking notes, but I wanted to share my notes to ensure we are all on the same page from our different perspectives.

My overall take was that there is excitement about the project, especially from key players. While there was some pushback, it was in the areas we anticipated (parking and traffic). I feel like there is a positive path forward. People often dislike when their streets are loaded with cars during events, but also do not like parking lots. Go figure. I was somewhat surprised (in a good way) to hear support about considering a parking deck versus a lot, especially after pushback in Grant Park over the deck a few years ago, but this expands options.

I also overheard several side conversations with people expressing excitement amongst one another, although they did not voice that to the whole group.

My notes from the ATC presentation at the ON Summerhill Neighborhood Meeting on July 6.

Feedback about the proposal:

1. ATC would need to celebrate in meaningful way the legacy of the site—the site of the first Public School for black children in Atlanta (i.e. E.P. Johnson ES)
- 2.
3. PARKING and TRAFFIC were definitely the biggest concerns:
 - a. PARKING
 - i. A small, but vocal, group did not like the surface parking proposal on the plan. Their reasons included:
 1. Too many spots—is there a way to reduce?
 2. Too much concrete that adds to heat dome (environmental concern)
 - a. Incorporate more greenspace/trees

- i. Note: A few attendees expressed support for the additional parking in the area.
- ii.

a. TRAFFIC

- i. Biggest concern would be event days, and what that would do with traffic and parking in the neighborhood.
- ii. They requested the Entry and Exit plan.
- iii. Is there a way to incorporate support from MARTA to reduce car traffic, especially with the new Rapid Bus Line on Hank Aaron.

4.

5. Environmental Concerns from the Construction, specifically FLOOD RISKS and WATER RUNOFF, which have historically been issues in Summerhill and Peoplestown.

- a. One attendee mentioned that previous studies when the district was considering building a municipal stadium. She mentioned those plans included some type of Water Tank. Worth looking its

6.

7. Loss of the field space where the proposed parking area would go.

Some suggestions I heard:

1. Related to Parking—a few attendees want there to be consideration of a parking deck, in lieu of a lot, that could provide the needed parking, but in a smaller footprint, allowing for more greenspace.

2.

3. Set-up another community meeting with a facilitator to provide an opportunity for additional feedback (definitely include sticky notes).

- a. *My Note: Consider opening with Gail Devers addressing the group. Her testimonial at the end was really powerful, as was the presence of the Gold Medals.*

4.

5. Ensure that the neighbors in immediate proximity to the area are part of the conversation.

6.

7. Communication: The community would want a clear calendar of major events that would impact traffic in the area. This is currently a major pain point between Georgia State University and Summerhill.

- a. Note: Atlanta Track Club has a history of being very communicative about major events throughout the city and metro-area so this should not be an issue.

A few random thoughts from me:

- For events (weekends/evenings): King MS parking could be an option for overflow/employees/volunteers
-
- Is there a way to lean in more on potential economic impact on Georgia Ave businesses? Perhaps ATC reaching out to them for support could help.

-
- Since the Olympic Torch is so near and dear to the community, advocating for it to remain could go a long way.
-
- Consider some type of nod to the APS schools (perhaps a mural with logos of the high schools). This was mentioned by one stakeholder, although she leaned more Maynard Jackson specific,

I know we meet tomorrow, so I am sure we will discuss more.
Again, I am very excited about this

Adam J. Danser, Ed.D.

Assistant Superintendent of Operations

Atlanta Public Schools | Division of Operations

Phone 404-802-2405

Email adanser@apsk12.org



ATLANTA
PUBLIC
SCHOOLS